

PERFUME SAMPLES ON WHATNOT - LEAN STARTUP BUSINESS PLAN

2-Person Operation | \$1,000 Starting Capital | Pre-Packaged Samples Only | Path to \$100K/Week

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

We buy **pre-packaged perfume sample packs** in bulk at volume discounts and sell them via Whatnot live shows. No decanting. No equipment. No gray areas. Buy sealed -> sell sealed.

Why This Works:

- Buy at \$1.50-\$5/unit in bulk, sell for \$5-\$15/unit live = 3-5x markup
 - Carded designer vials retail \$4-\$8+ each on resale markets
 - Discovery sets / mystery bundles = perfect live auction format
 - Lightweight shipping (<\$4/package), nearly zero breakage
 - Fragrance community is obsessive about sampling - insane repeat purchase rate
 - Year-round demand, spikes at holidays/Valentine's/Mother's Day
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SUPPLIER DIRECTORY - RANKED BY FIT

TIER 1: BEST FIT (Volume discounts + low minimums + credit potential)

1. Wholesale Perfumes NYC (wholesaleperfumesnyc.com)

WHY THEM: Best volume discount tiers. Pre-packaged units at \$2.25-\$3.00/piece. Starter packs from \$125.

Package	Units	Price	Per Unit
50pc Starter Package	50	\$125	\$2.50
100pc Starter Package	100	\$250	\$2.50
200pc Starter Package	200	\$500	\$2.50
400pc Transitional Package	400	\$1,000	\$2.50
500pc Intermediate Package	500	\$1,250	\$2.50
1000pc Advanced Package	1000	\$3,000 -> discounted	~\$2.25-\$2.50
1200pc Semi-Pro (Half Pallet)	1200	\$2,700	\$2.25
2400pc Professional (Full Pallet)	2400	\$4,200	\$1.75

- **Volume discounts:** Additional bulk pricing kicks in at 24 or 48 units of same item
- **Product type:** Impression/inspired-by fragrances (NOT designer originals) - high-quality clones of popular scents

- **Retail value:** Each piece retails \$39-\$49 (your cost: \$2.25-\$3.00)
- **Credit:** Contact sales for terms on repeat orders
- **Payment:** Credit cards, bank deposits, wire, Zelle, Cash App, Venmo
- **Best for:** High-volume show inventory, \$1-start auctions, mystery boxes

YOUR MOVE WITH \$1,000: Buy the 400pc Transitional Package (\$1,000) = 400 units at \$2.50 each. Sell at \$5-\$12/unit on Whatnot = \$2,000-\$4,800 revenue from first batch.

2. Faire.com (faire.com)

WHY THEM: NET 60 CREDIT LINE from Day 1. Free returns on first order from any brand. Wholesale marketplace with perfume sample packs.

Feature	Details
Credit Terms	**Net 60 - buy now, pay 60 days later**
Free Returns	First order from any brand = free returns
Minimum	Varies by brand (\$50-\$200 typical)
Product Types	Discovery sets, sample vial packs, carded samples, mini sprays

Available sample packs on Faire:

- Wholesale lots of 12 designer perfume sample vials + 4 extras (\$15-\$25 wholesale)
- 6-piece 2ml perfume spray vial sets
- 24-fragrance sample kits (10ml roll-ons)
- 21-piece 5ml scent sample boxes
- Discovery packs (11 fragrances + 5 free samples)
- Pack of 100 assorted scents

Net 60 = YOUR BEST FRIEND: Order \$500+ in sample inventory today, don't pay until 60 days from now. By then you've already sold it 4x over on Whatnot and pocketed the profit.

YOUR MOVE: Sign up, get approved (instant for most), order \$300-\$500 in sample packs on Net 60. Stack this WITH your \$1,000 cash at Wholesale Perfumes NYC = \$1,500 total inventory from Day 1.

3. United Perfumes (unitedperfumes.com)

WHY THEM: Authentic designer + Arabian fragrances wholesale. Miami-based. \$500 minimum. Quick quote process.

Feature	Details
Minimum Order	\$500 (can mix products or single units)
Brands	Designer (Dior, Versace, YSL, etc.) + Arabian (Lattafa, etc.)
Export pricing	Orders over \$2,500 get export price list
Payment	Bank transfer, Zelle, credit card, PayPal
Shipping	UPS Ground from Miami, same-day local delivery
Credit	Request credit terms for repeat buyers

Best for: Authentic designer testers, mini bottles, and gift sets you can break apart and sell individually on shows.

4. FragranceShop Wholesale (wholesale.fragranceshop.com)

WHY THEM: Since 1998. Authentic designer. Testers + gift sets + minis. \$500 min. Established wholesale program.

Feature	Details
Minimum Order	\$500
Products	Wholesale perfume testers, cologne testers, gift sets, minis
Brands	Designer names (Moncler, JPG, Yardley, etc.)
Pricing	40-60% below retail
Credit	Contact for terms on volume accounts

Key insight: Testers are full-size bottles without fancy packaging - cheaper wholesale, sell for near-retail on Whatnot because buyers don't care about the box.

5. Perfumes For Wholesale (perfumesforwholesale.com)

WHY THEM: Lattafa assorted boxes (30 pieces). Arabian fragrances are the HOTTEST trend in fragrance right now (Lattafa Asad did \$4.3M in a single month on TikTok Shop).

Feature	Details
Key Product	Lattafa Assorted Perfume Box - 30 pieces
Brands	Lattafa, designer brands, Arabian fragrances
Market fit	Arabian fragrances are #1 trending on TikTok + Whatnot fragrance community
Minimum	Contact for pricing

Why Arabian fragrances matter: Lattafa/Armaf/Afnan are "niche-inspired at accessible prices" - TikTok has made them viral. Buyers pay \$15-\$30 for bottles that wholesale at \$2-\$8.

6. Shoppex Corp (shoppexcorp.com)

WHY THEM: Lattafa specialist. Miami warehouse. Application-based = potential credit line for approved accounts.

Feature	Details
Minimum Order	\$2,500
Specialization	Lattafa fragrances (men's, women's, unisex)
Location	Miami, FL (local delivery within 50 miles)
Payment	Bank transfers, USDT, credit cards
Credit	**Application approval required** - email sales@shoppexcorp.com
Shipping	Free local, nationwide via USPS/FedEx/UPS

Products: No minimum on items over \$100. For items under \$100, minimum applies. Their best sellers include Lattafa Najdia, Sheikh Al Shuyukh Luxe, Raghba, Qaa'ed, Oud For Glory.

YOUR MOVE: Apply for account once you have first 2-3 weeks of Whatnot sales data to show. Request

credit terms.

7. ScentWholesalers (scentwholesalers.com)

WHY THEM: Private wholesale buying room. Searchable inventory. Direct sourcing requests.

Feature	Details
Access	Application required - private buying room
Products	Wholesale fragrance inventory, clean product data
Shipping	Buyer-paid
Best for	Scaling phase - once approved, access to consistent sourcing

TIER 2: LIQUIDATION / CLOSEOUT (Lowest cost per unit, bulk lots)

8. Closeout Explosion (closeoutexplosion.com)

WHY THEM: Up to 95% below retail. Shelf-pull perfumes, overstock lots. Perfect for mystery box inventory.

Feature	Details
Pricing	\$1.50-\$8 per unit for designer closeouts
Product types	Shelf pulls, overstock, liquidation lots
Contact	+1 (917) 913-6093
Credit	Negotiate on repeat orders - they want to move volume

A \$1,000 lot here could yield: 125-600+ units depending on brand mix. Mass-market overstock = \$1.50/unit. Designer closeouts = \$5-\$8/unit.

9. Vaal Enterprise Liquidation Pallets (vaalenterpriseliqpallets.com)

WHY THEM: Full pallets of designer + trending fragrances. Retail value \$10,000+ per pallet.

Feature	Details
Product	Mixed designer fragrance pallets
Retail Value	\$10,000+ per pallet
Pallet cost	Typically \$500-\$2,000 (varies)
Best for	Volume inventory once you're past Week 3

TIER 3: SCALE PHASE (Week 4+ when you have cash flow)

10. Alibaba / Accio Verified Suppliers

WHY THEM: Lowest per-unit cost at high volume. MOQ 24-1000 pieces. Lattafa wholesale at \$2.79-\$3.89/unit.

Supplier	MOQ	Price/Unit	Product
Shenzhen Surprise Adventure	24 pcs	\$2.79-\$3.89	Lattafa authentic
Hefei Tainuo New Energy Tech	24 pcs	\$2.80-\$3.89	Lattafa products
Zhejiang Meizhiyuan Cosmetics	varies	\$1.30-\$1.65	Perfume samples/sets

- Trade Assurance protection
- Bulk discounts on 100+ units
- Lead time: 7-21 days

11. Direct Brand Partnerships (Month 2+)

Contact smaller niche/indie perfume brands directly and propose:

- "We'll sell your sample packs on our Whatnot live show to 200+ engaged viewers"
- They provide inventory on consignment or at deep wholesale
- You take 30-50% of revenue
- They get marketing + customer exposure

THE \$1,000 LAUNCH PLAN - NO DECANTING

Day 1 Budget Allocation

Spend	Amount	What You Get
Wholesale Perfumes NYC - 100pc Sta..	\$250	100 impression fragrances
Faire.com - sample packs (on NET 6..	\$0 today (\$300 due in 60 days)	~40-60 branded sample s..
eBay/Mercari - designer carded via..	\$200	~50-80 carded designer ..
TJ Maxx / Marshalls run - mini set..	\$150	~15-25 mini bottles / g..
Shipping supplies (padded mailers,..	\$50	100+ mailers
Ring light + tripod (if needed)	\$50	Streaming setup
Giveaway samples + contingency	\$50	Show engagement
Faire.com paid portion (use remain..	\$250	Additional inventory
TOTAL CASH SPENT	**\$1,000**	
TOTAL INVENTORY VALUE	**\$1,000 + \$300 Faire credit =..	**250-400 sellable unit..

Revenue Projection From Initial \$1,000

Source	Units	Avg Sell Price	Revenue
Impression fragrances (Wholesale NYC)	100	\$6-\$10 (auction)	\$600-\$1,000
Faire sample sets (broken into singles)	50	\$5-\$8	\$250-\$400
Designer carded vials (eBay sourced)	60	\$5-\$8	\$300-\$480
TJ Maxx minis / gift sets	20	\$12-\$20	\$240-\$400
TOTAL	**230**	-	**\$1,390-\$2,280**

First 2 weeks gross margin: 40-130% ROI on initial \$1,000.

WHAT YOU'RE ACTUALLY SELLING (Product Types)

1. Impression/Inspired-By Fragrances (Wholesale Perfumes NYC)

- Clone/inspired versions of popular designer scents
- Full-size bottles at \$2.25-\$3.00 cost
- Retail value printed on them: \$39-\$49
- Sell on Whatnot: \$5-\$12 each (buyers know they're getting a deal)
- **Show format:** "\$1 start - smells EXACTLY like Sauvage, retail \$49, who wants it?"

2. Carded Designer Sample Vials (eBay lots, Faire, department store freebies)

- The little vials on cards you get at Sephora/Nordstrom counters
- Brands: Dior, Chanel, Tom Ford, Gucci, YSL, Prada
- Buy in lots of 20-100 for \$1-\$3 each
- Sell individually: \$4-\$8 each or in curated bundles of 5-10
- **Show format:** "10-piece designer sample lot - Chanel, Dior, Tom Ford - \$1 start!"

3. Mini Bottles & Travel Sizes (TJ Maxx, gift sets broken apart, Faire)

- 0.17oz - 1oz official miniatures
- Buy in gift sets at \$20-\$40 (contain 4-5 minis), sell each mini at \$8-\$15
- **Show format:** "Authentic Versace mini, 0.5oz - \$1 start!"

4. Arabian Fragrances (Lattafa, Armaf, Afnan) - TRENDING

- Full size bottles at \$2.80-\$8 wholesale
- Sell for \$15-\$30 on Whatnot (TikTok has made these viral)
- **Show format:** "Lattafa Oud For Glory - the \$20 Initio Oud dupe that broke TikTok - \$1 start!"

5. Discovery/Sample Sets (Faire, brand direct)

- Pre-packaged sets of 5-12 sample vials in branded boxes
- Buy wholesale: \$8-\$20/set
- Sell: \$18-\$40/set or break apart and sell individually
- **Show format:** "Mystery Discovery Box - 8 designer samples, sealed - \$1 start!"

6. Testers (FragranceShop Wholesale, United Perfumes)

- Full-size bottles without retail packaging
- Buy: 40-60% below retail
- Sell: near-retail (buyers don't care about the box)
- **Show format:** "100ml Sauvage TESTER - same juice, no box - \$1 start!"

2-PERSON ROLES

Person 1: THE HOST

- Runs all live shows (2-3 hours each)
- Describes scents, builds energy, engages chat
- Creates social media clips from show highlights
- Builds community (knows regulars by name)

Person 2: THE OPERATOR

- Sources all inventory + manages supplier relationships
- Lists items on Whatnot pre-show
- Packs and ships all orders (same-day / next-day)
- Manages finances, tracks margins per product type
- Handles Faire / supplier reorders
- Manages social media accounts

SHOW FORMAT - PERFUME SAMPLES

Show Structure (2-3 hours)

MIN 0-5:	Intro + giveaway announcement ("free sample to a random buyer tonight!")
MIN 5-15:	\$1 START FRENZY - carded designer vials, one at a time, rapid fire
MIN 15-60:	CORE SELLING - impression bottles, Arabian fragrances, minis Show each item, describe the scent profile, name the designer it clones/compa 60-90 seconds per item, start at \$1 or \$3
MIN 60-90:	BUNDLE ROUND - "Lot of 5 random designer samples" / "Mystery box of 10" Curated themed bundles: "Date Night Pack" / "Office Scents" / "Summer Fresh"
MIN 90-120:	HIGH TICKET - testers, full-size Lattafa, sealed gift sets
MIN 120-150:	CLEARANCE - everything remaining at \$1 start, rapid liquidation
POST-SHOW:	Pack + ship immediately

Show Themes That Drive Revenue

Theme	What You Sell	Best Day
\$1 Friday Frenzy	Everything starts \$1, volume night	Friday
Mystery Monday	Sealed mystery bundles, buyers don't know contents	Monday
Arabian Night	Lattafa, Armaf, Afnan - the TikTok viral scents	Wednesday
Designer Sample Haul	Carded vials, minis - Dior, Chanel, Tom Ford	Tuesday
Ladies Night	Women's fragrances only	Thursday
Full Size Auction	Testers + full bottles, high ticket	Saturday

FUNDING & CREDIT STRATEGY

Week 1-2: Bootstrap (\$1,000 + Faire Net 60)

Source	Capital Available	Cost
Your \$1,000 cash	\$1,000	-
Faire Net 60 credit	\$300-\$500	\$0 now, pay in 60 days
Total inventory power	**\$1,300-\$1,500**	-

Week 3-4: Reinvest + Add Credit (\$5K-\$15K)

Source	Capital	Speed	Terms
Reinvested revenue (100% back in)	\$3,000-\$6,000	Immediate	Free
0% APR credit card (new card promo)	\$5,000-\$10,000	3-5 days	0% for 12-18 mon..
Faire - larger Net 60 orders	\$1,000-\$2,000	Instant	Pay in 60 days
Wholesale Perfumes NYC - negotiate t..	Request Net 15..	After 2-3 paid ord..	Ask

Week 5-8: Scale Capital (\$25K-\$100K)

Source	Capital	Speed	Terms
Revenue-Based Financing (Onramp, 8fig)	\$25K-\$100K	48-72hrs	6-12% of daily ..
Shoppex Corp account (Lattafa credit)	\$2,500+	After approval	Application-based
Business line of credit (Bluevine, Mercury)	\$10K-\$50K	1-2 weeks	8-15% APR
Supplier credit lines (negotiate with all suppl..)	Varies	Relationship-ba..	Net 30/60

The Credit Stacking Strategy

The goal: **never spend your own money on inventory once you have velocity.**

Week 1: Cash (\$1K) + Faire Net 60 (\$500) = \$1,500 inventory

Week 2: Revenue reinvest (\$1,500) + Faire reorder (\$500) = \$2,000

Week 3: Revenue (\$3K) + 0% APR card (\$5K) + Faire (\$1K) = \$9,000
 Week 4: Revenue (\$6K) + supplier credit (Net 30) + card = \$15,000+
 Week 6: RBF (\$50K) + multiple supplier Net 30/60 = unlimited scale

Key insight: Faire's Net 60 is essentially a \$0-interest loan. You sell the inventory on Whatnot within 1-2 weeks, pocket the profit, then pay Faire on day 59. Rinse and repeat.

6-WEEK REVENUE RAMP

Week	Inventory Spend	Shows	Revenue	Cumulative Profit
1	\$1,000 cash + \$500 Faire	3	\$1,200-\$1,800	(\$300)
2	\$1,500 reinvest + \$500 Faire	5	\$3,000-\$4,500	\$700
3	\$3,500 + \$5K credit card	8	\$8,000-\$12,000	\$3,500
4	\$8,000 (supplier credit flowing)	12	\$18,000-\$25,000	\$9,000
5	\$15,000 (RBF approved)	16	\$35,000-\$50,000	\$18,000
6	\$25,000+	20	\$60,000-\$85,000	\$30,000

Honest assessment: \$60-\$85K/week by Week 6 is achievable with execution + the 0% APR card injection at Week 3. To hit \$100K/week at Week 6, you'll need either:

- A \$25K angel/partner injection at Week 3, OR
- RBF approved by Week 4 (requires 3-4 weeks sales data)
- Both the above push you to \$100K+ at Week 6

UNIT ECONOMICS

Per-Show Revenue Target (at scale)

Metric	Week 1-2	Week 3-4	Week 5-6
Items listed per show	50-80	100-150	200-300
Avg items sold	30-50	70-120	150-250
Avg sell price	\$6-\$8	\$7-\$10	\$8-\$12
Revenue per show	\$200-\$400	\$700-\$1,200	\$1,500-\$3,000
Shows per week	3	8-12	16-20

Margin Structure at Scale

Line Item	% of Revenue
COGS (inventory)	30-40%
Whatnot fees (11%)	11%
Shipping (net)	5-8%
Marketing / giveaways	2%
Supplies (mailers, labels)	2%
Gross profit	**37-50%**

SHIPPING - KEEP IT CHEAP

USPS Rules for Perfume

- Perfume IS mailable USPS Ground Advantage (NOT air)
- Max 16 oz per package
- Seal in secondary packaging (ziplock bag)
- Absorbent material in packing
- Mark "Surface/Ground Only" or ORM-D

Packing Process (Person 2)

1. Vial/bottle in bubble wrap
2. Into small ziplock bag (secondary containment)
3. Into padded mailer or small box
4. Tissue or paper as absorbent
5. Label via Whatnot integrated USPS shipping

Costs

- Padded mailer: \$0.20-\$0.40 (bulk from Amazon/Uline)
- USPS First Class (under 4oz): \$3.50-\$4.50
- Charge buyer \$3-\$5 flat ship on Whatnot -> nearly break even on shipping

IMMEDIATE NEXT STEPS (THIS WEEK)

Day 1

- [] Apply for Whatnot seller account (if not approved yet)
- [] Sign up for Faire.com as a retailer (instant approval typical)
- [] Order 100pc Starter Package from Wholesale Perfumes NYC (\$250)
- [] Browse Faire for perfume sample packs eligible for Net 60

Day 2

- [] Hit TJ Maxx / Marshalls / Ross - buy every discounted mini set and gift set you find (\$150 budget)
- [] Check eBay for "designer perfume sample lot" listings (buy 2-3 lots, \$200 budget)
- [] Order padded mailers bulk from Amazon (\$50)
- [] Set up streaming area (ring light, phone/camera, clean background, shelf for bottles)

Day 3

- [] Faire order placed (Net 60 - \$300-\$500)
- [] Create TikTok + Instagram accounts
- [] Film 3-5 short clips: "Look what just arrived" unboxing content
- [] Study Whatnot fragrance sellers - watch 2-3 shows, note pricing/pacing

Day 4

- [] List all inventory on Whatnot (photos + descriptions)
- [] Schedule first show for Day 5 (evening, 7-10 PM EST)
- [] Plan show rundown: which items first, bundles, giveaways
- [] Post "First show tomorrow!" on social media

Day 5: FIRST SHOW

- [] Go live. Everything starts at \$1. Build engagement + ratings.
- [] Give away 2-3 free samples to random buyers
- [] Goal: 15-30 sales, 4.8+ rating, 50+ followers
- [] Ship everything same night or next morning

Day 6-7

- [] Ship all remaining orders
- [] Analyze: What sold? What didn't? What got the most bids?
- [] Reinvest 100% of revenue into more inventory
- [] Reorder from Wholesale Perfumes NYC (scale up to 200pc)
- [] Schedule next 3 shows for following week

KEY SUPPLIERS - QUICK REFERENCE

Supplier	Best For	Min Order	Credit?	Contact
**Wholesale Perfum..	Impression fragrances, b..	\$125 (50pc)	Ask after 2-3..	wholesaleperfumesn..
Faire.com	Sample sets, discovery p..	~\$50-\$200..	**NET 60 from..	faire.com
United Perfumes	Authentic designer whole..	\$500	Request for r..	unitedperfumes.com
**FragranceShop Wh..	Testers, gift sets, desi..	\$500	Contact for t..	wholesale.fragranc..
**Perfumes For Who..	Lattafa boxes (30pc), de..	Contact	Contact	perfumesforwholesa..
Shoppex Corp	Lattafa specialist, Miami	\$2,500	**Application..	shoppexcorp.com
**Closeout Explosi..	Liquidation lots, cheape..	Varies	Negotiate	closeoutexplosion...
ScentWholesalers	Private wholesale room	Apply	Apply	scentwholesalers.com
Alibaba/Accio	Lattafa at \$2.80-\$3.89/u..	24 pcs	Trade Assurance	alibaba.com

SCALING PATH

Stage	Weekly Re	Inventory Budg	Key Supplier Move
Launch	\$1-2K	\$1,000 + Faire..	Wholesale NYC 100pc + Faire Net 60
Traction	\$5-10K	\$3,000-\$5,000	Add United Perfumes (\$500 min), Closeout Explosion
Velocity	\$20-40K	\$10,000-\$15,000	Apply: Shoppex Corp, ScentWholesalers. Negotiate Net 30..
Scale	\$60-100K	\$25,000-\$40,000	RBF funding, pallet-rate pricing, multiple supplier cre..
Beyond	\$100K+	\$50K+	Direct brand partnerships, exclusive distro deals, 2nd ..

Two people. One grand. Pre-packaged samples. Faire's Net 60 is your secret weapon on Day 1. Wholesale Perfumes NYC is your volume engine. Arabian fragrances (Lattafa) are your viral TikTok-to-Whatnot funnel. Execute.